Elaine Dabin Jeon

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Mixed-methods health researcher and former management consultant focused on youth mental health, human-AI interaction in behavioral health, and health equity. Specializes in participatory and co-design research that centers communities and end users in defining problems and solutions.

EDUCATION

University of Southern California, Annenberg School for Communication & Journalism — *Los Angeles, CA*
PhD in Communication, Health Communication Track | GPA: 4.0 — *08/2024 – Present*
Committee: Robin Stevens (Chair), Angel Hwang, Lindsay Young, Hans Oh (Social Work)

Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health — *Boston, MA*
Master's in Public Health, Health and Social Behavior | GPA: 4.0 — *08/2022 – 05/2024*

Tsinghua University — *Beijing, China*
Master's in Global Affairs, Schwarzman Scholars Fellowship (link) | GPA: 4.0 — *08/2021 – 06/2022*

Amherst College — *Amherst, MA*
Bachelor's in Economics, with Distinction | GPA: 3.7 — 08/2013 – 05/2017

SELECT EXPERIENCE

Industry:

Oliver Wyman — *Singapore, Thailand, Qatar*
Engagement Manager — *09/2017 – 06/2021*

- Led 12 health, digital tech, and financial services engagements; supervised 10 analysts; and maintained relationships with and presented to senior stakeholders, including health ministry leaders and C-suite at banks
- Contributed to the design of a national digital population health program serving 377K+ Singaporeans to improve chronic disease outcomes, synthesizing health ministry capabilities and data for the technology partner (link)
- Interviewed 50+ long-term care operators and policymakers and published an 85-page report on COVID-19 challenges and future opportunities for tech-enabled solutions (link)
- Identified operational challenges through 10+ interviews with Qatar's health sector leaders and recommended a new governance model, including roles and responsibilities, accountability mechanisms, and capacity building
- Developed go-to-market strategy, product propositions, and UI/UX design for a new digital retail bank
- Managed Asia's social impact practice, including designing and launching 8 projects with non-profit partners

Research:

AA+NHPI Youth Suicide Prevention Research, Little Tokyo Service Center — *Los Angeles, CA*
Consultant *(PI: Peter Gee)* — *01/2026 – Present*

- Plan, recruit, and lead an 18-month youth participatory action research program (*n* = 10) for suicide prevention

Human-AI Ecosystem (HAE!) Lab, USC Annenberg — *Los Angeles, CA*
Graduate Researcher *(PI: Angel Hwang)* — *09/2025 – Present*

- Conduct a scoping review on AI's impact on youth's social development and skills
- Delivered a mixed-methods youth co-design study end-to-end in 6 months: developed workshop curriculum and materials, incorporated feedback from 7 experts, facilitated a 13-participant workshop, and synthesized qualitative and quantitative findings into a 10,000-word report on user needs and design preferences

Health Equity and Media Lab, USC Annenberg — *Los Angeles, CA*
Graduate Researcher *(PI: Robin Stevens)* — *09/2024 – Present*

- Design national survey questions for youth's AI chatbot use for mental health; clean and standardize survey data (*n* = 1,500) using STATA; and run regression and sensitivity analyses using R
- Created curriculum for and facilitated a 6-week youth environmental justice research program (*n* = 26)

RAND Corporation — *Los Angeles, CA*
Pro Bono Researcher *(PI: Laura Bogart)* — *09/2024 – 05/2026*

- Developed a detailed study protocol for a 6-month longitudinal study on social disconnectedness and health outcomes among older Black men who have sex with men

- Authored a journal article on quantitative PrEP use data among immigrant Latino men who have sex with men

Department of Social & Behavioral Sciences, Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health *Boston, MA*
Research Assistant *(PIs: K. "Vish" Viswanath, Christy Denckla, Shoba Ramanadhan)* *02/2023 – 05/2023*

- Categorized and cleaned qualitative data from 4,000+ text sources in the Nurses' Health Study and researched key variables to include in statistical modeling
- Developed focus group discussion materials with East Boston Social Centers on loneliness among older adults
- Conducted a systematic review of implementation science literature by evaluating 144 journal articles

Division of Global Health Equity, Brigham and Women's Hospital *Boston, MA*
Research Assistant *(PIs: Bisola Ojikutu, Khady Diouf, Laura Bogart)* *09/2022 – 05/2024*

- Adapted evidence-based group- and individual-level HIV prevention programs to culturally appropriate, virtually delivered interventions for African-born immigrant women in MA and NY
- Devised pre-/post-intervention surveys to measure behavioral and attitudinal changes; interviewed 12 pilot participants and conducted thematic analysis for intervention feasibility and acceptability testing
- Developed the longitudinal study workflows, authored a 50-page manual, and trained 10 research assistants for a multi-site randomized controlled trial targeting 424 participants
- Created all intervention materials (e.g., virtual session presentations, participant guide), coordinated IRB and Clinicaltrials registration, updated multi-year work plans, and managed internal and external communication

SELECT PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

Publications:

- **Jeon, E. D.,** Bogart, L. M., ... (2026). Correlates of PrEP cascade outcomes among immigrant Latino men who have sex with men. *AIDS and Behavior*
- **Jeon, E. D.,** … & Hwang, A. H.-C. (2026). Co-designing AI for mental health support with young adults of color (YOC): Needs, expectations, and implications for AI literacy [Preprint]. *arXiv*
- Hillcoat, A., **Jeon, E. D.,** ... (2026). Detecting risk for depression and anxiety symptoms among older bereaved women using text-based analysis in the Nurses' Health Study II. *American Journal of Epidemiology*
- Bunyi, J., … **Jeon, E. D.,** … Oh, H. (2026). Conversations before apps: Social networks and digital mental health engagement among Asian American emerging adults. *SSM – Qualitative Research in Health*
- Xie, L., Jang, K., **Jeon, E. D.,** ... (2026). Children's participation in digital environments: Forming digital publics through media-based activism [ICA Proceedings]. *Digital Futures for Children Centre, LSE & 5Rights Foundation*
- Ramanadhan, … **Jeon, E. D.,** ... (2026). How power is conceptualized and operationalized in evidence-based intervention implementation: A scoping review. *Implementation Science*
- Malika, N., … **Jeon, E. D.,** ... & Ojikutu, B. O. (2025). Evaluating the cultural adaptation of evidence-based HIV prevention interventions for African immigrant women. *Journal of Immigrant and Minority Health*
- **Jeon, E. D**. & Jing, J. (2023). A study of end-of-life care communication and decision-making in China by exploring filial piety and medical information concealment. *Asian Journal of Medical Humanities*

Conference presentations & lectures:

- Examining U.S. mpox news through stigma communication model: A content analysis. *ICA 2026*
- Recruitment & engagement strategies for African immigrants in HIV prevention research. *CHIPTS HIV 2025*
- End-of-life care communication in China. *USC COMM 324: Intercultural Communication – Lecture 2025 & 2026*

SELECT AWARDS

- Engagement Award: Capacity Building, Patient-Centered Outcomes Research Institute ($300,000 – team) (2026)
- Community-Engaged Research Grant, USC Dornsife Equity Research Institute ($7,500) (2025)
- Outstanding Master's Thesis Award, Tsinghua University (2024)
- Early-Career Funding for Global Catastrophic Biological Risks, Coefficient Giving ($136,800) (2022)

SKILLS

- **Qualitative research:** Co-design, interview, focus group, youth advisory board, thematic & content analysis
- **Quantitative research:** Survey design, experimental design, statistical modeling, computational content analysis
- **Programming & data analytics:** R, Stata, Python
- **Software:** Microsoft Office Suite, Figma, REDCap, Qualtrics, Nvivo, Dedoose, Zotero, Covidence
- **Language:** Korean & English (native), Spanish (intermediate), Mandarin (elementary, HSK 2)